BCA152 MICROCONTROLLERS — B186

Smart Plant Monitoring System

Using ESP32, FreeRTOS, and Internet Communication Services

Technical report · Project No. 1

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Adaptations and verification limits are identified in the report.

Abstract

This project implemented an ESP32-S3 monitoring and notification prototype using C, ESP-IDF, and FreeRTOS. A potentiometer provided repeatable simulated moisture input, while a DHT11 measured air temperature and relative humidity. Separate acquisition, monitoring, notification, and reconnection tasks coordinated through queues, event-group flags, and task notifications. Readings were acquired every five seconds; three successive valid samples in the same classification confirmed a state. DRY and WET notifications used independent fifteen-minute cooldowns. The device received Wi-Fi credentials through BLE provisioning, synchronized its clock, and initiated verified TLS requests to Gmail, Telegram, Discord, and Slack.

The final delivery experiment showed one NORMAL event, measured at 2026-10-26 05:23:26 UTC, in all four recipient applications with identical values: 45% simulated moisture, 30.0 C, and 72.0% relative humidity. Sequential dispatch completed in 14.680 seconds from state confirmation to the final Gmail submission-accepted log. Six monitoring unit tests passed. Controlled experiments also demonstrated stale-sample rejection, duplicate-alert suppression, bounded Slack retry behavior, and reconnection after a device-originated Wi-Fi disconnect. The results establish the observed prototype behavior, not soil calibration, measurement accuracy, guaranteed delivery, or full reliability under prolonged faults. Remaining limitations include intermittent DHT11 timeouts, incomplete numeric and live new-layout tests, absent retry policies for three services, and an unfinished final demonstration.

Keywords: ESP32-S3; ESP-IDF; FreeRTOS; BLE provisioning; sensor validation; TLS; event-driven notification.

Report organization

Sections 1–6 describe the problem, hardware, sensor interpretation, firmware, connectivity, and API design. Sections 7–8 present methods and measured results. Sections 9–11 discuss the findings, requirement coverage, limitations, and conclusions. References and appendices provide the evidence index and reproduction procedure.

The editable Markdown and rendered PDF describe the same implementation. Figures use the actual assembly photograph, source-derived architecture, and recorded recipient outputs. No illustrative mockup is used as experimental evidence.

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1. Problem and objectives

1.1 Problem statement

A monitoring device should turn repeated sensor readings into useful condition updates without sending a message at every sample. It should distinguish a stable change from a brief input fluctuation, continue essential acquisition during communication, and expose failures rather than presenting failed measurements as valid values. The BCA152 project brief requires this behavior through ESP-IDF, active FreeRTOS coordination, secure networking, genuine external delivery, and reproducible documentation [1].

This prototype addresses those requirements on an ESP32-S3 N16R8. Its input is a potentiometer-based moisture simulation, complemented by DHT11 environmental readings. The work focuses on monitoring and notifications. Automatic watering, a custom mobile application, an MQTT broker, a cloud database, and machine learning are outside its implemented scope.

1.2 Objectives

1. Acquire and validate sensor inputs on a five-second schedule.
2. Convert ADC readings into a documented simulated index and classify DRY, NORMAL, and WET states.
3. Confirm changes using three consecutive valid readings and suppress repeated identical alerts during cooldown.
4. Separate hardware acquisition, processing, communication, and network recovery through FreeRTOS tasks and signaling.
5. Provision Wi-Fi through BLE, reuse saved credentials, synchronize time, and retain certificate verification.
6. Deliver one captured event through four selected Internet services and compare visible recipient outputs with device logs.
7. Record unit, integration, fault-injection, compiler, and static-analysis results with their limits.

1.3 Adaptations and interpretation of requirements

The original brief specifies a capacitive soil sensor, DHT22, Gmail, WhatsApp, Telegram, and X. The available prototype uses a potentiometer, DHT11 HW-481 V0.2, Gmail, Telegram, Discord, and Slack. Instructor permission for these adaptations was reported during development. The report preserves the distinction: potentiometer output is a simulated input index, Discord is not WhatsApp delivery, and Slack is not X posting. The original requirement matrix and the adapted evidence are compared in Section 10.

The potentiometer permits controlled state transitions but does not reproduce soil-sensor characteristics, plant needs, or soil water content. Likewise, successful transport and recipient delivery do not establish agronomic suitability. These boundaries are part of the experimental interpretation, not missing details to be inferred from screenshots.

2. Hardware and wiring

2.1 Components and electrical connections

Table 1. Hardware components and electrical roles.

Component	Function	Connection or configuration
ESP32-S3 N16R8	Processing, Wi-Fi, BLE	16 MB flash configured; module designation includes 8 MB PSRAM, whose use remains unverified
Potentiometer	Simulated moisture input	Outer terminals across 3V3/GND; center wiper to GPIO1
DHT11 HW-481 V0.2	Air temperature and humidity	S to GPIO2, VCC to 3V3, minus to GND
Breadboard and jumpers	Interconnection	Common supply reference and ground
USB data cable	Power, programming, console	Serial monitor configured for 115200 baud
Android phone	Initial network configuration	Espressif ESP BLE Provisioning application

GPIO1 is configured as ADC1 channel 0, with 12-bit width and 12 dB attenuation. GPIO2 is used for the DHT11 data line. The firmware enables its internal pull-up. The module's external pull-up was not independently measured. The physical pin labels on the actual board must take precedence over diagrams for other ESP32 variants [2,3].

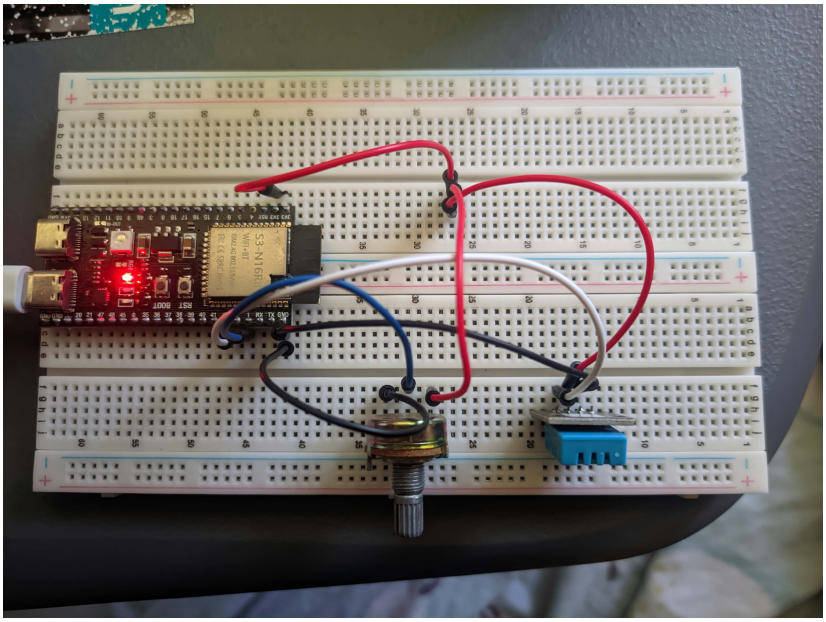


Figure 1. Actual bench assembly: ESP32-S3 at left, potentiometer below, and DHT11 module at right. Some terminal labels are obscured; the electrical diagram defines the intended nets.

2.2 Wiring diagram and configuration history

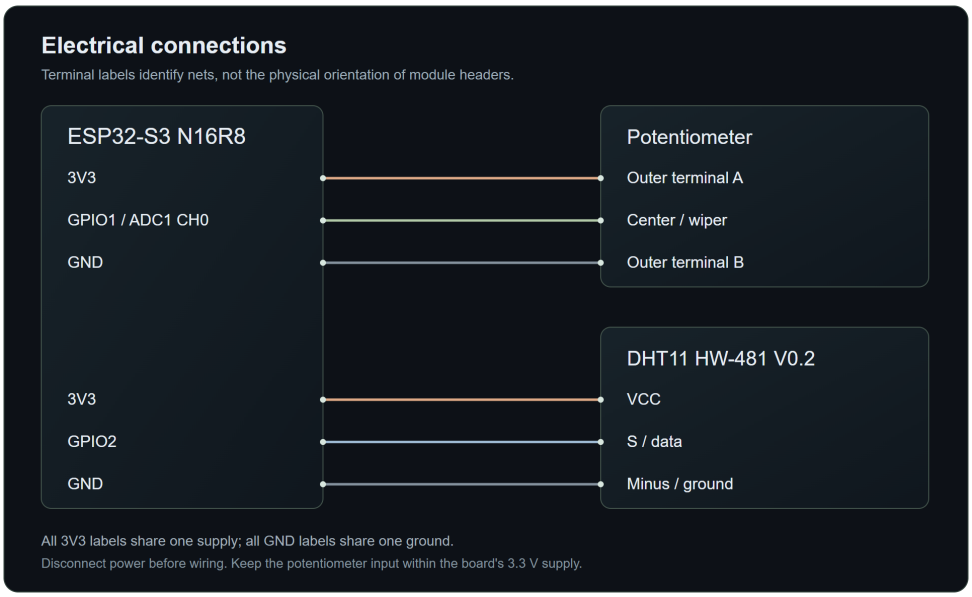


Figure 2. Electrical-net diagram for the current prototype. Repeated 3V3 and GND labels indicate shared nets, not extra physical pins.

Power should be disconnected before modifying the circuit. The potentiometer center remains the ADC connection if outer terminals are exchanged to reverse turn direction. Left-decreases/right-increases was discussed, but a separate direction acceptance test was not recorded.

The base PlatformIO profile is `esp32-s3-devkitc-1`. Its printed N8 description does not identify the physical module. ESP-IDF flash configuration was changed from an initial 2 MB to 16 MB. A separate custom partition table enlarged the factory application slot from 1 MB to 4 MB after networking and BLE increased binary size. Physical flash capacity and app-partition capacity are different settings. The current partition table has no OTA app slots.

2.3 Build environment

Table 2. Recorded development environment.

Item	Recorded value
Language and framework	C; `framework = espidf`
PlatformIO Core	6.2.0
Static analyzer	Cppcheck 2.11; reported scope `src`
Espressif32 platform	7.1.2
ESP-IDF	6.1.0
Xtensa toolchain package	`15.2.0+20251204`
DHT component	`esp-idf-lib/dht` 1.2.0
Network provisioning component	`espressif/network_provisioning` 1.3.2
JSON component	`espressif/cjson` 1.7.19~2

Component hashes and resolved versions are tracked in `dependencies.lock`. The platform entry itself remains unpinned, so a fresh installation may resolve a different tool set. Reproducibility is aided by recorded versions but has not been established through a separate clean-clone build of the final documentation checkpoint. No Arduino framework or Arduino-style application structure is used.

3. Sensor interpretation and validation

3.1 Simulated moisture index

The conversion is:

```
simulated_percent = (raw * 100) / 4095
```

Integer division truncates the result. Raw 0 maps to 0%, and raw 4095 maps to 100%. The mapping does not claim calibrated voltage, linear knob angle, or physical soil moisture. ADC saturation near an endpoint is possible.

Table 3. Simulated moisture classification thresholds.

Simulated index	Classification	Bench interpretation
Below 30%	DRY	Low test input
30–70%, inclusive	NORMAL	Middle test input and recovery state
Above 70%	WET	High test input

Stationary raw ranges of 3345–3355 and 1814–1819 were observed at two knob positions. Those observations suggest small variation at those positions during the recorded runs; they are not a noise characterization or accuracy estimate. No software smoothing was added. The thresholds were chosen for repeatable demonstration rather than a specific plant.

For a real capacitive soil sensor, calibration would require dry and sufficiently wet reference samples, documentation of supply and sensor placement, response-direction determination, endpoint-based conversion, and repeat tests. None of those soil calibration measurements was performed with this potentiometer prototype.

3.2 Validation and independent sensor health

ADC driver failures retain their error code. Successful values outside 0–4095 are rejected. Successful DHT readings must be finite, with humidity within 0–100%. Caller outputs update only after successful validation. A finite but physically implausible temperature may still pass because a DHT-specific temperature range is not implemented.

The ADC and DHT results are independent fields in each reading. A failed DHT transaction does not prevent a valid moisture classification; temperature/humidity are reported as unavailable. DRY or NORMAL refers to the simulated moisture classification, not a declaration that every sensor is healthy. An in-range ADC voltage also cannot prove that a potentiometer is connected correctly.

3.3 Confirmation and freshness

Three successive valid samples in the same classification confirm a state. Numeric values may differ within the same classification. A new candidate restarts the streak. ADC errors, discarded stale samples, or detected sequence gaps reset it. Holding an already confirmed state does not repeatedly confirm it. This is consecutive-reading persistence, not separate hysteresis entry and exit bands.

Each sample carries an acquisition-start timestamp from `esp_timer_get_time()`. Monitoring rejects negative age or age greater than ten seconds. Exactly ten seconds is accepted by the comparison but was not separately tested. This monotonic check works before Internet clock synchronization. It applies when monitoring consumes a sample, not before each later external delivery.

4. ESP-IDF and FreeRTOS architecture

4.1 System organization

The firmware separates peripheral acquisition, monitoring logic, connectivity, and service senders. `app_main()` starts application tasks and connectivity. Public component headers define interfaces; CMake declares source files and dependencies. ESP-IDF provides FreeRTOS, drivers, networking, TLS, logging, and NVS [2,4].

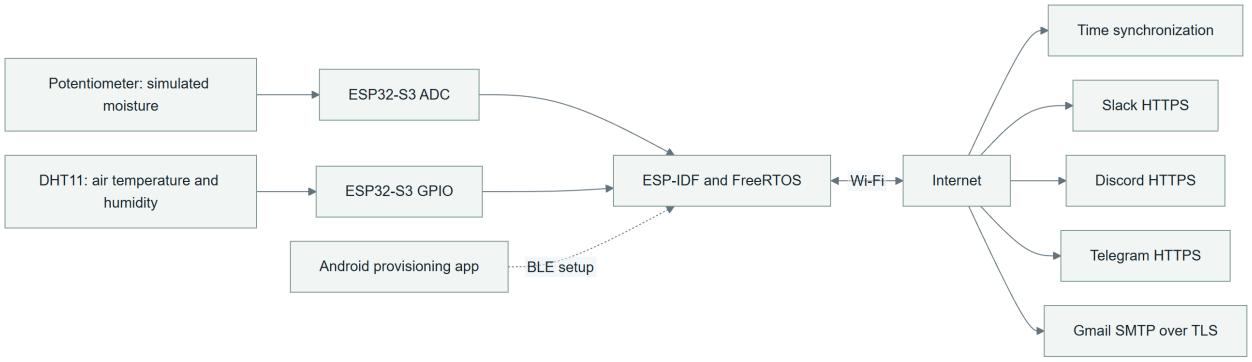


Figure 3. System block diagram. BLE is the setup path; Internet notifications use Wi-Fi.

4.2 Task scheduling and signaling

Table 4. Application task priorities, allocated stacks, and responsibilities.

Task	Priority	Allocated stack	Responsibility
Sensor	5	4096 bytes	Initialize/read ADC and DHT; timestamp and enqueue samples
Monitoring	4	4096 bytes	Check sequence/age; classify, confirm, and evaluate cooldown
Notification	3	8192 bytes	Format captured event and call four service senders
Wi-Fi reconnect	3	4096 bytes	Wait for notifications; reconnect with backoff

The sensor task uses `vTaskDelayUntil()` with a five-second period. Monitoring and notification tasks block on their input queues. Wi-Fi reconnection uses task notifications and readiness flags. Queues have four elements each and use nonblocking sends. An allocation/task-creation failure is checked, while a full queue logs a dropped item.

Priorities give sensing precedence over lower-priority work but are not a measured hard real-time guarantee. Tasks are not explicitly pinned to cores. Stack values are allocations, not measured remaining margins.

4.3 Ownership and inter-task communication

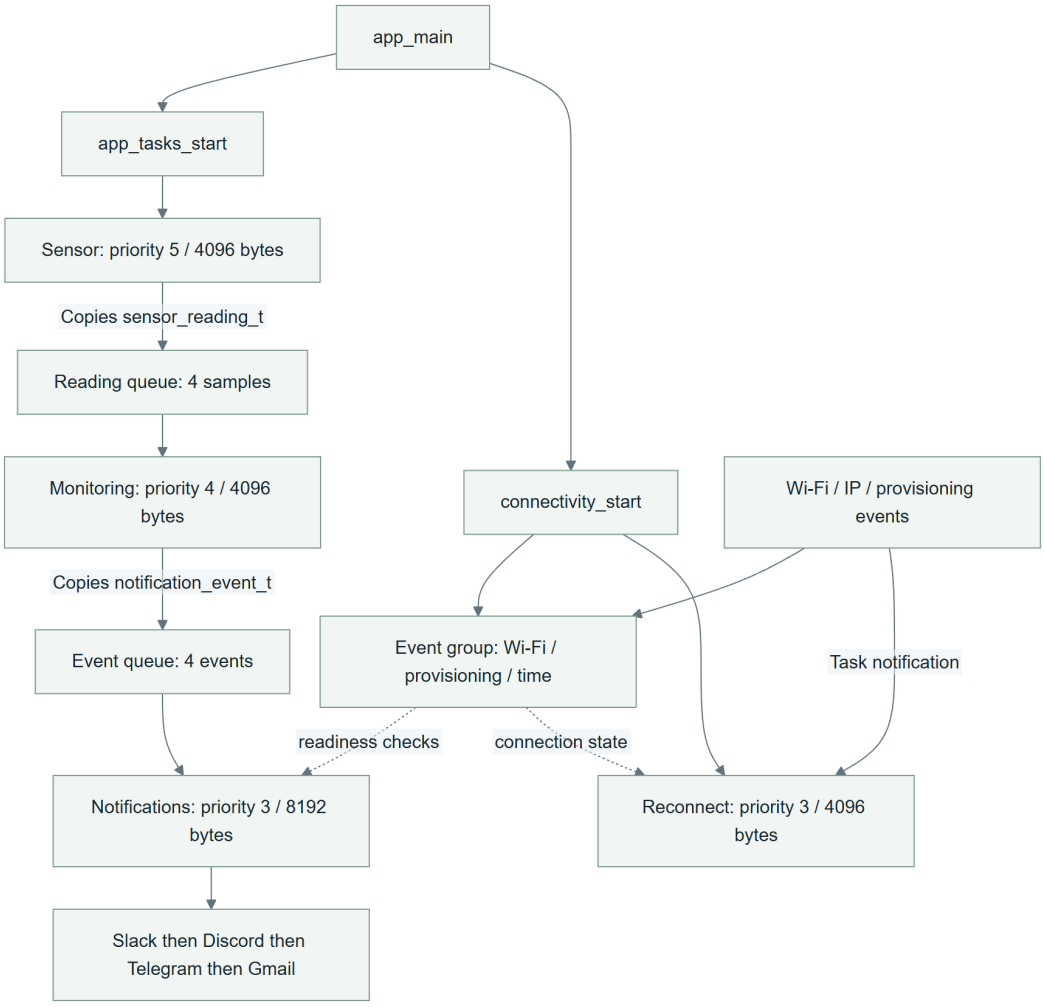


Figure 4. Task-level architecture, queue ownership transfers, event-group flags, and reconnect signaling.

The sensor task owns hardware acquisition. `sensor_reading_t` contains a sequence number, monotonic time, optional UTC time, raw ADC value, DHT values, and separate result codes. Queue sends copy the structure by value, so a subsequent acquisition cannot overwrite a queued sample.

The monitoring task owns its `monitoring_t` object. A notification event copies the reading, interpreted percentage, and state string into the second queue. Only the notification task calls senders. Slack's static rate-limit state therefore assumes a single caller. Wi-Fi readiness, provisioning state, and time readiness are represented by event-group bits; Wi-Fi/IP/provisioning callbacks signal the reconnect task.

When a reading queue overflows, the next received sequence gap can break confirmation. A notification-queue drop does not roll back the confirmed state and is not automatically replayed. There is no persistent event store or delivery acknowledgment per recipient.

4.4 Processing path



Figure 5. Sample processing from sequence/freshness validation to confirmation, cooldown, and dispatch. DHT health is tracked independently.

4.5 Reading and maintaining the source

Appendix C maps the source files, interfaces, build declarations, and error boundaries. The longer walkthrough is in docs/code-guide.md. The shared notification formatter adds PhST/native presentation while preserving sensing, monitoring, and queue-based cooldown behavior.

5. Network provisioning and transport security

5.1 BLE onboarding and saved credentials

The Android ESP BLE Provisioning app sends credentials to the ESP32 through NimBLE using Espressif's `network_provisioning` component. The unprovisioned device advertises a name beginning `PROV_PLANT_`. A generated proof-of-possession code is printed locally for security-version-1 onboarding. It must be treated as private setup material [5].

After successful setup the configured BLE cleanup releases Bluetooth memory, and NVS retains Wi-Fi credentials. On later boots, station mode starts with those saved credentials. BLE is not the message transport. An earlier teardown run logged advertising error `rc = 30`; provisioning and later saved-credential connection worked, but the teardown issue was not fully diagnosed.

5.2 Reconnection and time

Wi-Fi disconnection clears the ready bit and notifies a dedicated reconnect task. Retry delays grow from one second to two, four, eight, sixteen, then at most thirty seconds. Provisioning state prevents the reconnect task from taking over association while the manager is configuring it. A temporary disconnect does not require a board restart.

SNTP uses `pool.ntp.org`. Its synchronization callback sets time readiness, and healthy-DHT messages retain the acquisition-time UTC value. All senders require both network and synchronized time. Readiness does not automatically replay an initial event that failed before connectivity was available. A user-facing command to erase/reprovision saved Wi-Fi credentials is not implemented.

5.3 TLS and credential boundaries

All integrations use ESP-IDF's root certificate bundle. Full-bundle and cross-signed verification support are enabled. Certificate validity-date checking is enabled through `CONFIG_MBEDTLS_HAVE_TIME_DATE=y`; verification is not disabled to make a test pass. Successful requests after enabling this setting demonstrate compatible operation, not rejection of expired or not-yet-valid certificates.

Private webhook URLs, bot token/chat ID, and SMTP credentials are defined in ignored `components/notifications/config.local.h`. A tracked example contains placeholders. Git ignore rules reduce accidental staging but cannot undo earlier disclosure, and secrets remain present in compiled firmware. Flash encryption, secure boot, and encrypted credential storage were not demonstrated. The printed BLE setup code and private recipient identifiers also require care in public captures.

HTTPS clients have ten-second configured timeouts and disable automatic redirects. SMTP uses verified immediate TLS on port 465 with reply-code checks and bounded reply processing. These mechanisms do not establish a hard total deadline for a multi-command session or for all four sequential senders.

6. Notification design and service integration

6.1 Initial, alert, and recovery behavior

The confirmed state starts as UNKNOWN. Three matching samples establish the initial state; later confirmed transitions create eligible events. At a five-second sampling period, the first-to-third sample span is approximately ten seconds, plus the initial acquisition delay. Initial reports, alerts, and recovery events currently share the reason string `confirmed moisture state`.

DRY and WET each have a default fifteen-minute cooldown stored in `monitoring_t`. NORMAL recovery remains eligible. Cooldown begins after successful queue insertion rather than after completed delivery, and it resets on reboot. Holding a state produces no periodic reminders. A suppressed transition is not automatically sent once cooldown expires. Failed events are not durably replayed.

6.2 Payload and dispatch

Each sender receives one captured notification_message_t snapshot. The formatter shows state, simulated moisture, environmental readings, reason, and measured time. It converts a copy of UTC Unix time to twelve-hour PhST (UTC+08:00), leaving the captured timestamp and process timezone unchanged. Failed-DHT and unknown-clock paths retain explicit availability labels and the measured-time field, correcting the earlier omission.

Limits are 768 bytes for plain/Telegram and 6144 for HTML. Gmail stacks HTML readings with a plain alternative, inline PNG, and responsive/inline styling. Slack uses full-width sections/fallback text; Discord uses six non-inline fields, no spacer, and disabled mentions. Telegram retains wrapping HTML. Inter has client fallbacks. Dispatch remains Slack, Discord, Telegram, Gmail, without dispatch-age checking or durable replay.

Table 5. Selected services, transport/authentication, and acceptance checks.

Service	Transport/authentication	Acceptance criterion
Slack	HTTPS native blocks and fallback text; private webhook URL	HTTP 200; response body not independently checked for `ok`
Discord	HTTPS embed; disabled mention parsing; `wait=true`	HTTP 200
Telegram	HTTPS `sendMessage`; HTML parsing; bot token and chat ID	HTTP 200 plus JSON `ok: true`; response overflow detected
Gmail	SMTP/TLS at `smtp.gmail.com:465`; app password via AUTH LOGIN	Expected codes, including authentication 235 and post-DATA 250

The selected APIs are direct device integrations, not a hosted relay [6–9]. Provider account requirements and future pricing remain outside the firmware's control. No claim of unlimited free access is made.

6.3 Retry and rate policy

Only Slack has an automatic retry loop. It permits up to three attempts, with approximately two- then four-second waits for selected temporary errors. For 429 responses it uses numeric `Retry-After`. A missing/invalid delay pauses Slack until restart. A required wait over the thirty-second waiting budget abandons that event while retaining the next-request deadline. Ambiguous failures can result in duplicate requests.

Discord, Telegram, and Gmail return failures without automatic retry. Account expiration and the full response/error matrix are not comprehensively tested. API acceptance is logged, but visible recipient output remains necessary evidence of delivery.

7. Test methodology

7.1 Evidence sources and experimental scope

Evidence consists of the saved source/configuration, device serial excerpts, unit-test output, analysis records, the actual assembly photograph, and recipient screenshots. Earlier integration records describe different firmware milestones and measurement times. The final matching-event experiment is treated separately so it cannot be inferred from unrelated screenshots.

The test records contain single observed runs or controlled experiments; they do not provide a statistical sample sufficient for reliability estimates, latency distributions, or accuracy claims. Repeated code paths and synthetic time checks supplement hardware observations but do not replace external delivery evidence. Exact source-to-binary provenance was not established for every historic capture.

7.2 Test procedures

Table 6. Test procedures and their acceptance observations.

Experiment	Procedure	Acceptance observation
Normal sensing and confirmation	Move potentiometer through ranges; hold for three samples	Classification confirmed after third valid match; acquisition continues
Unit tests	`pio test -f test_monitoring` using Unity on ESP32-S3	Six named cases pass without failures
Cooldown	DRY, then NORMAL, then DRY in one boot inside fifteen minutes	First DRY/NORMAL dispatched; repeated DRY suppressed
DHT disconnection	Disconnect signal in a controlled bench test; later restore	Explicit errors without false DHT values; ADC monitoring continues
Stale sample	Temporarily subtract eleven seconds from third sample timestamp	Rejection resets streak; three fresh samples needed
Wi-Fi recovery	After IP acquisition, request one ESP32 disconnect	Disconnect detected; retry and new IP acquisition
Slack fault injection	Inject 503 or 429/delay inside sender	Bounded attempts and requested waits; no uncontrolled loop
Four-channel event	Confirm NORMAL and inspect all recipients	Identical timestamp and values visible in four applications
Build/analysis	Clean build, warning search, `pio check --skip-packages`	Recorded build result and analysis findings, including limitations

Temporary test triggers were removed after their tests. Cleanup runs verified normal operation after retry/stale/disconnect injection. Unit testing replaces the running application with test firmware; the production application was subsequently uploaded and normal sensing/service acceptance was observed.

7.3 Timing interpretation

Serial timestamps are device uptime in milliseconds, whereas message timestamps are captured UTC measurement time. Their roles are distinct. Sequential completion times are calculated relative to confirmation in one run. They include earlier senders and local processing and must not be interpreted as isolated provider latency or arrival time at the recipient.

The cooldown tests use synthetic monotonic timestamps. The duration reported by PlatformIO includes build and upload, not only assertion execution. The old-timestamp experiment injects age; it does not create a real queue backlog. These methodological limits constrain the conclusions in Section 9.

8. Results

8.1 Matching four-channel delivery

One NORMAL event appeared in Gmail, Telegram, Discord, and Slack with the fields in Table 7. The redacted Gmail image retains the measurement contents. Earlier DRY entries in the Discord/Slack captures are distinct events and are not counted as the matching observation. Appendix A shows all four recipient captures.

Table 7. Shared event identity verified in four recipient screenshots.

Field	Observed value
Device	Plant-01
Measurement time	2026-10-26 05:23:26 UTC
Reason	confirmed moisture state
State	NORMAL
Simulated moisture	45%
Temperature	30.0 C
Relative humidity	72.0%

Candidate samples were 33%, 42%, and 45%, all NORMAL. Confirmation occurred at uptime 207502 ms and used the third sample. The record therefore demonstrates consecutive classification persistence, not a requirement for identical numeric values.

Table 8. Sequential dispatch observations for the matching event.

Observation	Uptime, ms	Elapsed from confirmation
NORMAL confirmed	207502	0.000 s
Slack request accepted	209392	1.890 s
Discord request accepted	212672	5.170 s
Telegram request accepted	215342	7.840 s
Gmail server accepted after DATA	221872	14.370 s
Gmail submission accepted after closing session	222182	14.680 s

Slack, Discord, and Telegram returned HTTP 200. Gmail showed authentication 235, DATA continuation 354, post-DATA 250, and QUIT 221. Recipient visibility supplies proof beyond the serial acceptance logs. Sensor samples at 212502, 217502, 222502, and 227502 ms showed the five-second interval continuing during dispatch. These observations do not establish worst-case scheduling or network guarantees.

8.2 Unit tests

All six current Unity cases passed. The build/upload/test run took 123.671 seconds; this is not pure test-execution time. The screenshot is Figure 10 in Appendix A.

Table 9. Current monitoring unit-test cases and observed results.

Test	Result	Property exercised
`test_threshold_boundaries`	Passed	29% DRY; 30%/70% NORMAL; 71% WET
`test_confirmation_and_no_repeat`	Passed	Third-match confirmation, no repeated confirmation while held
`test_error_reset_breaks_streak`	Passed	Explicit reset requires three new matching readings
`test_repeated_dry_waits_fifteen_minutes`	Passed	Eligibility before/at 900000000 microseconds
`test_dry_and_wet_have_independent_cooldowns`	Passed	Separate condition timestamps
`test_cooldown_does_not_block_recovery`	Passed	NORMAL eligibility during cooldown

The earlier three-test baseline is retained as historical evidence. Raw conversion, formatting, numeric rejection, physical ADC errors, sequence gaps, and queue pressure are outside the six-case monitoring suite. Presentation now has separate host coverage described in Section 8.5.

8.3 Fault behavior and cleanup

Table 10. Fault and policy experiments, results, and evidence boundaries.

Experiment	Recorded result	Boundary of the evidence
Hardware cooldown	DRY confirmed at 12.503 s, NORMAL at 27.503 s, repeated DRY suppressed at 42.503 s	Fifteen-minute expiry checked synthetically, not by a full hardware wait
Stale injection	Third sample rejected at 12.503 s; fresh counts at 17.513/22.513/27.513 s; DRY then confirmed	Injected timestamp, not actual queue backlog; exact threshold/future-time cases untested
Stale cleanup	DRY confirmation returned near 12.513 s without forced warning; services accepted event	Normal restored behavior in supplied run
DHT disconnection	Four DHT timeouts while potentiometer monitoring continued; later good reads returned	Does not establish live hot-plug recovery or measurement accuracy
Intermittent DHT fault	Timeouts at 122.513 and 352.513 s recovered next sample	Underlying communication cause unresolved
Wi-Fi disconnect	Event at 20424 ms; attempt at 21424 ms; IP at 25254 ms	About 4.83 s recovery for device-originated disconnect; router outage untested
Slack injected 503	Three attempts; waits about 2.01 and 4.01 s	Injection bypassed actual server/header processing
Slack injected 429	Injected 3 s delay; attempts at 12469/15499/18509 ms	Header parsing and broader error cases not tested
TLS date setting	Four service requests succeeded with date checking enabled	Expired/not-yet-valid certificate rejection untested

8.4 Compiler and static analysis

The recorded clean build succeeded. A search for `warning:` and `warning!` in its saved output returned no matches. This is a compiler-diagnostics review under configured flags, not proof of defect-free firmware.

Cppcheck passed with zero high, zero medium, and two low findings after a shadowed `now_us` declaration was removed. The remaining low findings were `unusedFunction` reports for `app_main`, which ESP-IDF invokes, and `app_tasks_start`, which is called from `src/main.c`. They were retained as analysis limitations rather than used to remove necessary functions.

The documentation-review run verified Cppcheck 2.11 and reproduced the result: zero high, zero medium, and two low findings. The tool version and command output are retained in `docs/results/static-analysis-output.txt`. PlatformIO identifies scope `src`; custom-component coverage remains unestablished. Recording the version closes the earlier tool-identification gap, but does not extend the analyzed scope.

8.5 Native layouts, PhST, and offline email checks

Seventeen C formatting cases passed using GCC 14.2.0 and real cJSON. They cover captured PhST conversion, year rollover, twelve-hour midnight/noon, unknown-clock and failed-DHT labels, bounds/truncation, native payload structure, state colors, and JSON allocation-failure cleanup. The same suite passed under the default host timezone and explicit UTC0/PST8PDT settings. This is separate from the six ESP32 monitoring cases.

Three complete offline Gmail sessions used the actual sender source copied beside dummy configuration, fake SMTP replies, and forced seventeen-byte partial writes. Python's MIME parser verified plain/HTML alternatives, the inline PNG, captured or unavailable values, Base64 line limits, and one DATA terminator. A fourth failed-write scenario checked connection cleanup. A review identified the required multipart/related root type parameter; an added assertion failed before the parameter was corrected and passed afterward.

The responsive follow-up passed 30 browser layout cases at 320, 360, 390, 430, 768, and 1280 pixels, including missing readings/time, all state badges, and an inline-style fallback. The tests check stacked order, essential content, image loading, timestamp bounds, and horizontal overflow. The 17 host cases and simulated SMTP sessions passed again. Firmware compilation succeeded in 42.36 seconds; static RAM was 42,064 bytes and flash 1,349,941 bytes. Earlier Cppcheck results remain a separate checkpoint. No provider was contacted. Actual mail/chat-client rendering, new-layout hardware receipt, and ESP32 stack margins remain unverified; earlier UTC screenshots remain historical evidence.

9. Discussion

9.1 What the observations support

The matching-event experiment establishes visible receipt of one captured event through the four selected services. Matching plant ID, UTC time, state, moisture index, temperature, humidity, and reason provide an event-level comparison. The result is stronger than four unrelated screenshots or a serial log that only says a request was accepted.

Sensor readings continued during the fourteen-second dispatch sequence in that run. This supports the purpose of separating acquisition and communication tasks. It does not prove absence of jitter, worst-case deadlines, or indefinite operation under repeated failures. The measured completion intervals also do not rank the services by intrinsic speed because dispatch is sequential.

The cooldown tests support suppression of a rapid repeated DRY transition while allowing NORMAL recovery. Independent cooldown timestamps avoid making a DRY alert consume WET eligibility. However, recording cooldown on enqueue creates a delivery trade-off: an event may consume eligibility even when no recipient ultimately receives it. Persistent per-channel delivery state would be needed for stronger guarantees.

9.2 Validation versus physical confidence

The sensor wrapper distinguishes driver failure from valid output and prevents use of failed DHT values. The freshness experiment demonstrates that an old sample can break a confirmation streak. Those checks improve interpretation, but numeric branch rejection is not experimentally established by normal input runs. Physical sensor disconnection can also produce an in-range ADC value, and finite temperature is not necessarily plausible temperature.

The potentiometer supports controlled low/middle/high transitions. It cannot establish soil calibration, sensor sensitivity to soil conditions, plant-specific thresholds, or agronomic usefulness. DHT11 measurements likewise lack a reference-instrument comparison. These omissions prevent a claim that the prototype measures actual plant water need accurately.

9.3 Reliability and security interpretation

A single controlled disconnect demonstrates one reconnection path, not general outage robustness. Similarly, Slack injection verifies the bounded logic exercised, not live parsing of every provider error. Most other service failure cases remain untested. The absence of a queue overflow in supplied logs does not establish adequate capacity under sustained load.

Certificate bundles and date checking remain enabled, and real requests succeeded. This supports configuration and compatibility; a negative certificate test would be required to demonstrate rejection directly. Private source headers and sanitized configuration reduce repository exposure, but secrets remain in firmware and at-rest protections were not evaluated.

The DHT startup adjustment reduced the observed initial-read problem, yet later timeouts show the broader issue remains. A brief unintended low pulse during direction switching is a working hypothesis, not a measurement-backed root cause. The report therefore separates the observed improvement from a confirmed explanation.

9.4 Provenance and reproducibility limits

The documentation checkpoint is `67f1157`, which records the matching-event experiment. The restored application boot log displayed `1b65beb`; the matching-event excerpt does not independently identify its exact firmware commit. The checkpoint identifies the documentation/evidence state, not a proven source-to-binary identity for every run. No author-specific contribution or test-execution attribution is inferred from the screenshots.

10. Requirement coverage and limitations

10.1 Acceptance matrix

Table 11. Laboratory acceptance cases mapped to current evidence.

Case	Evidence	Assessment
T1 Startup and sensing	Periodic ADC/DHT readings, units, synchronized measurement times	Observed with intermittent DHT failures; failed-DHT/time formatting fixed and tested offline
T2 Calibration and dry/wet states	Potentiometer mapping and three-state demonstration	Adapted; real soil calibration absent
T3 Invalid sensor reading	DHT errors/disconnection; wrappers; injected stale sample	Partial; numeric branch and physical ADC fault coverage missing
T4 Notification policy	Real confirmed transitions, cooldown experiment, logic tests	Observed within stated queue-based/reboot limits
T5 Connectivity loss	Controlled device disconnect and IP reacquisition	Partial; prolonged/router outage and exact sensing continuity unproven
T6 Service error/rate limit	Injected Slack 503/429 and attempt bounds	Partial; header/parser and other-channel handling incomplete
T7 Four-channel delivery	Four matching recipient captures and serial acceptance	Historical four-channel receipt; new PhST/native layouts await live verification
T8 Restart and recovery	Saved credentials reused; startup observations	Observed; systematic repeated-cycle/endurance test pending

The original brief grades Gmail, WhatsApp, Telegram, and X independently. This report does not rename a Discord message as WhatsApp or a Slack message as an X post. The reported instructor permission should accompany the submission explanation for the adapted channel set.

10.2 Remaining implementation and verification work

- Obtain actual dry/wet soil reference measurements before replacing simulated moisture claims with soil calibration.
- Investigate intermittent DHT timing and validate temperature plausibility/measurement accuracy.
- Verify new PhST/native layouts on actual recipients and distinguish initial, alert, and recovery reasons.
- Add raw conversion, sensor-layer invalid-number, sequence-gap, freshness-boundary, and queue tests; retain the new offline formatting/MIME checks.
- Measure task stack margins and endurance under concurrent communication failures.
- Complete retry/rate-limit/error policies for Discord, Telegram, and Gmail; exercise real Slack header parsing and ambiguous transport failures.
- Add a controlled reprovisioning mechanism and test prolonged connectivity loss.
- Evaluate dispatch-age handling, durable events, and per-channel delivery state if eventual-delivery guarantees are required.
- Establish custom-component static-analysis coverage and repeat a clean-clone build; Cppcheck 2.11 is now recorded.
- Complete the narrated video or instructor-directed live demonstration.

11. Conclusion

The prototype implemented modular ESP-IDF firmware that acquires inputs, confirms simulated moisture states, coordinates concurrent tasks, provisions Wi-Fi through BLE, and sends notifications using verified TLS connections. The strongest delivery result is one event visibly received through all four selected channels with the same measurement timestamp and values. Six monitoring tests passed, and controlled experiments established the specific cooldown, stale-input, retry, and reconnection behaviors described in the results.

These results demonstrate an embedded monitoring and notification workflow. They do not establish actual soil moisture calibration, sensor accuracy, guaranteed eventual delivery, complete service-error handling, or prolonged reliability. The potentiometer/DHT11 and Discord/Slack substitutions remain explicit. The system is suitable for demonstrating the recorded engineering behavior; full acceptance depends on the instructor's adaptation agreement and completion of the remaining verification and demonstration work.

References

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[7] Discord. Webhook resource. https://docs.discord.com/developers/resources/webhook

[8] Telegram. Bot API. https://core.telegram.org/bots/api

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[10] ESP-IDF-Lib. DHT component 1.2.0. https://components.espressif.com/components/esp-idf-lib/dht/versions/1.2.0

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Appendix A. Recipient and unit-test evidence

The matching event is the NORMAL message measured at 2026-10-26 05:23:26 UTC, with 45% simulated moisture, 30.0 C, and 72.0% RH. The Gmail sender address is covered. Earlier DRY entries visible in Discord and Slack are not part of the matching-event comparison.

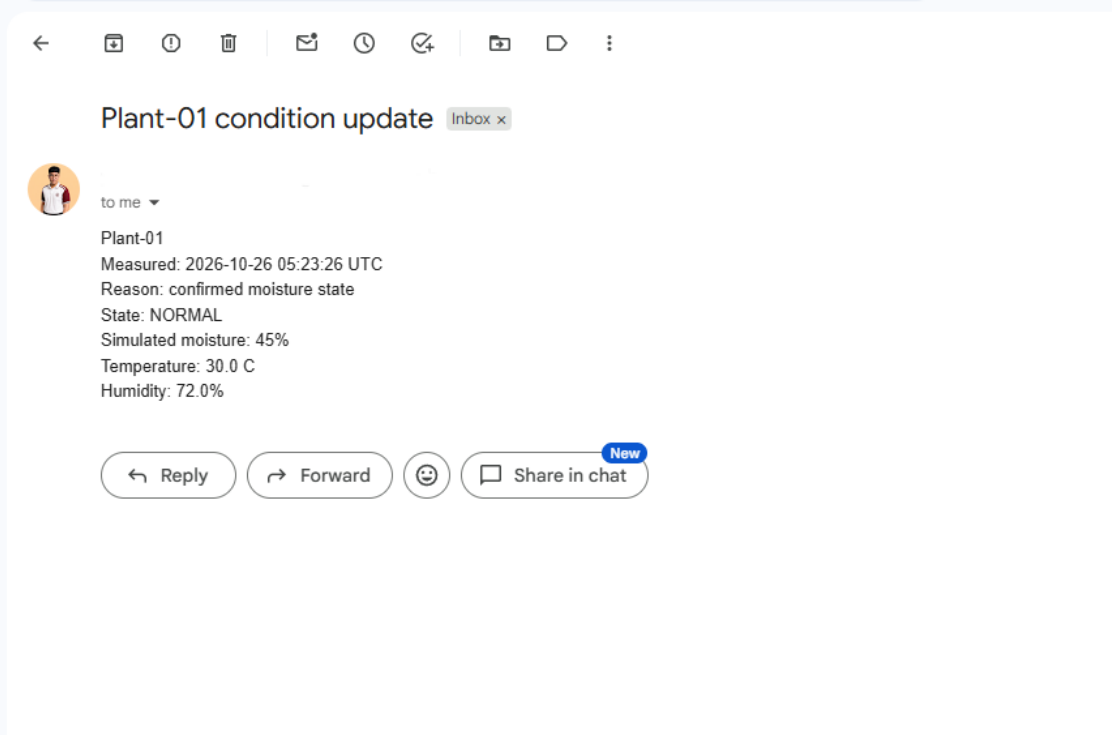


Figure 6. Gmail inbox receipt of the matching NORMAL event. Sender address redacted; the measurement contents remain visible.

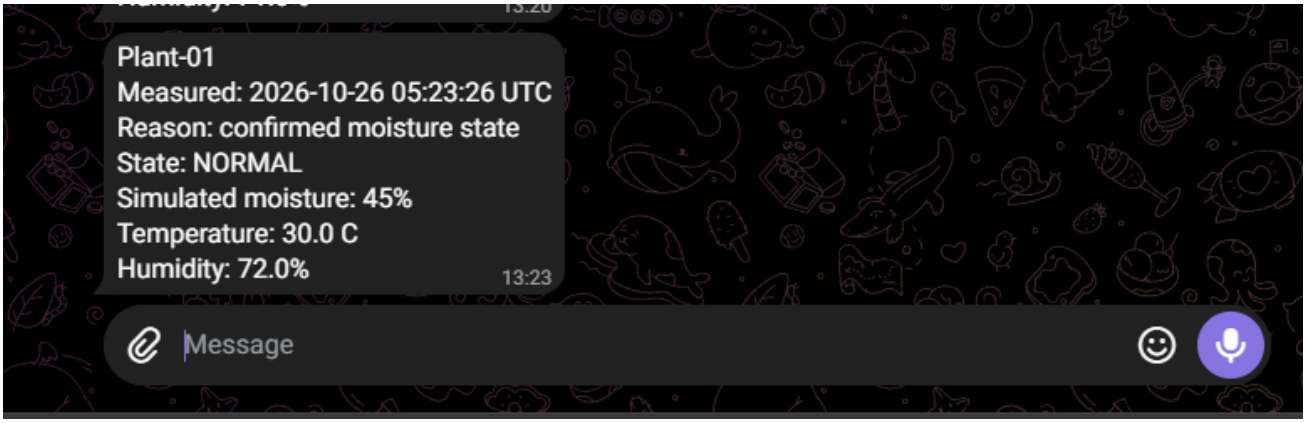


Figure 7. Telegram bot-chat receipt of the same measurement event.

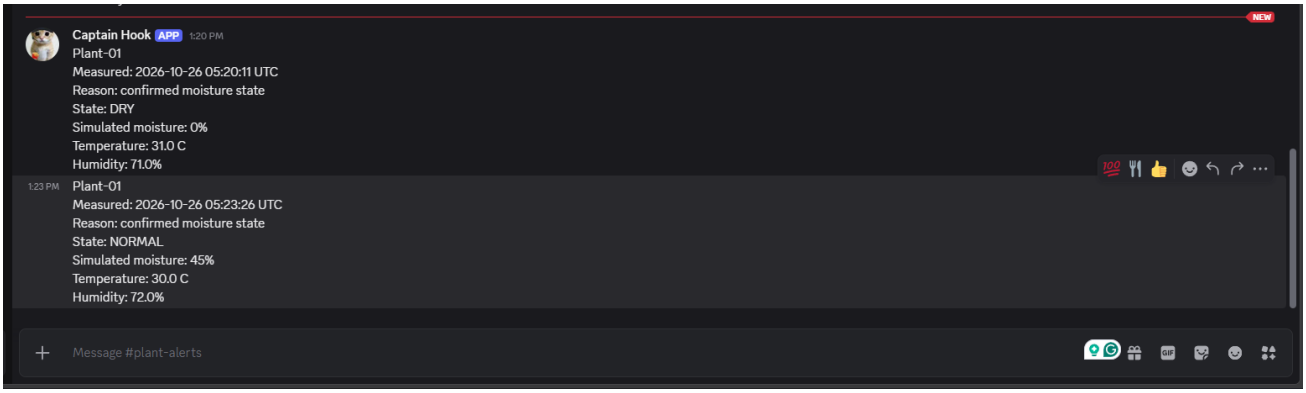


Figure 8. Discord channel receipt. The lower NORMAL message matches the final event; the upper DRY message is earlier.

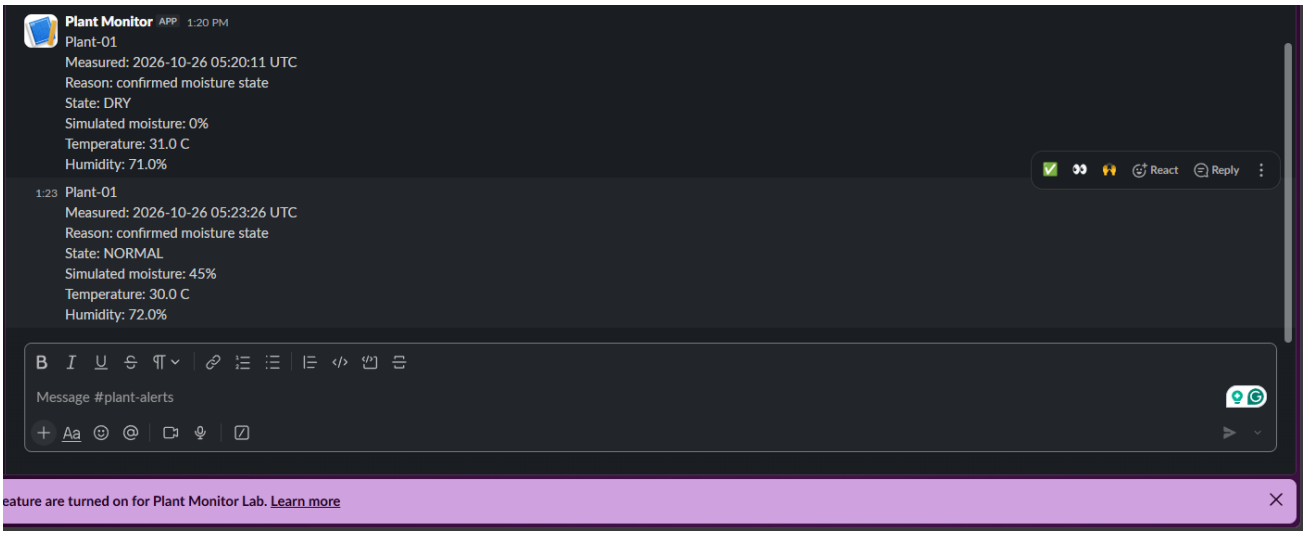


Figure 9. Slack channel receipt. The lower NORMAL message matches the final event; the upper DRY message is earlier.

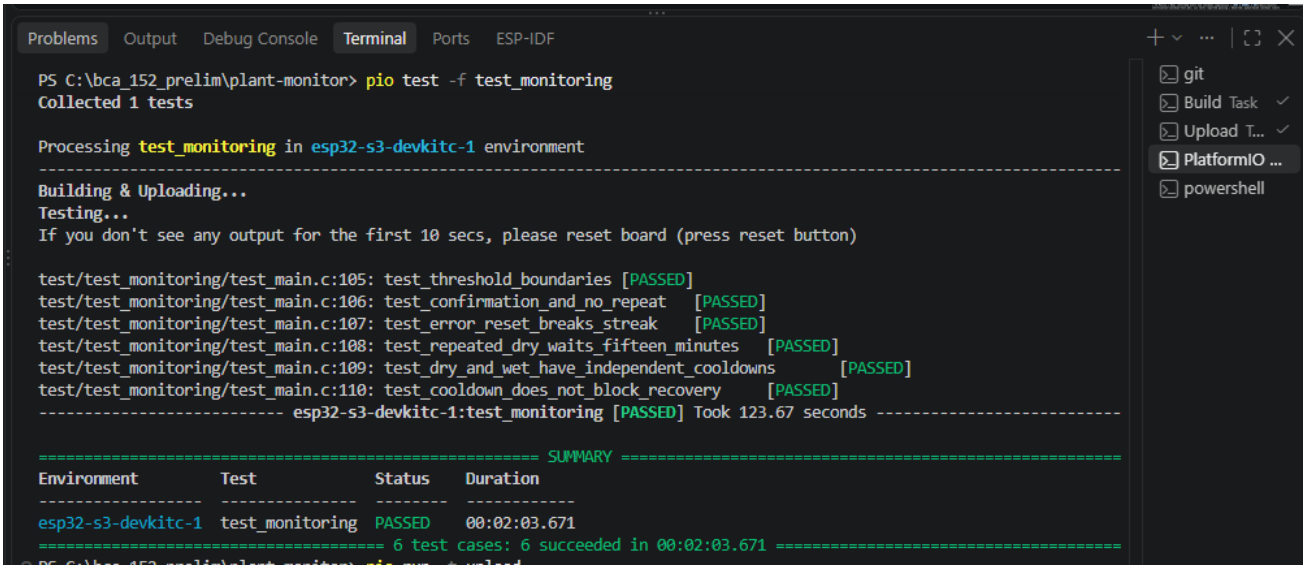


Figure 10. Unity terminal evidence showing all six current monitoring cases passed. Total build/upload/test duration was 123.671 seconds.

Evidence index

Table 12. Repository evidence index.

Repository record	Subject
`docs/results/four-channel-delivery-test.md`	Shared event, serial excerpts, recipient comparison
`docs/results/monitoring-unit-tests.md`	Six-case run, screenshot, restored application, earlier baseline
`docs/results/notification-cooldown-test.md`	Hardware DRY/NORMAL/DRY suppression
`docs/results/stale-sample-test.md`	Injected old timestamp and cleanup
`docs/results/dht11-disconnection-test.md`	Missing DHT communication and later good reads
`docs/results/sensor-validation-test.md`	Validation regression and intermittent timeouts
`docs/results/wifi-reconnection-test.md`	Device-initiated disconnect/recovery
`docs/results/slack-retry-test.md`	Injected 503/429 policy checks and cleanup
`docs/results/tls-date-validation-test.md`	Successful operation with date checking enabled
`docs/results/compiler-build-check.md`	Clean build and warning search
`docs/results/static-analysis.md`	Cppcheck results, scope, unresolved findings
`docs/progress.md`	Historical milestones and investigations

Appendix B. Reproduction procedure

B.1 Build and private configuration

Open the repository folder containing `platformio.ini`. Copy the safe template once when the local header does not exist:

```
Copy-Item components/notifications/config.example.h components/notifications/config.local.h
git check-ignore components/notifications/config.local.h
pio run
pio run -t upload
pio device monitor
```

Populate the private header with the Slack and Discord webhook URLs, Telegram token/chat ID, and Gmail sender/app-password/recipient. Do not publish those values. Gmail's tested app password has sixteen characters without display spaces. All network requests are initiated by the ESP32. The README documents each service's account setup and official source.

Use the tracked ESP-IDF configuration, 16 MB flash override, and 4 MB factory partition. Component manifests and `dependencies.lock` record the managed dependencies. If adding source files changes the build graph, verify CMake SRCS and dependencies; the component-refresh script handles the configuration-change issue encountered during development.

B.2 Demonstration sequence

1. Connect the hardware according to the pin table and electrical diagram.
2. Upload production firmware. If unprovisioned, configure Wi-Fi from the Android app using the private name/setup code.
3. Wait for IP acquisition and time synchronization.
4. Hold a low input until DRY confirms, then a middle input until NORMAL confirms, then a high input until WET confirms.
5. Compare the captured measurement fields and time in all four recipient applications.
6. Return through NORMAL to DRY within its cooldown, without rebooting, and show local confirmation with notification suppression.
7. Keep serial sampling visible during dispatch. Explain that queued events retain acquisition-time values.
8. Show the actual circuit, architecture, selected service credentials procedure without exposing secrets, and the stated limitations.

B.3 Tests and restoration

```
pio test -f test_monitoring
pio run -t upload
pio device monitor
pio check --skip-packages
```

Unit testing uploads a different application; production upload is necessary afterward. The optional clean compiler review is:

```
pio run -t clean
pio run 2>&1 | Tee-Object -FilePath build-check.log
Select-String -Path build-check.log -Pattern 'warning:|warning!'
```

The report and README document existing evidence. Their presence does not remove the need to reproduce required behavior during the instructor-directed demonstration.

Appendix C. Source files and data connections

C.1 Runtime path

ESP-IDF invokes `app_main()` in `src/main.c`. Application queues/tasks are created before connectivity startup. Acquisition can therefore run while Wi-Fi and time are not ready. The sensor task calls the sensors interface, sends a copied `sensor_reading_t` through `reading_queue`, and wakes on a five-second schedule. Monitoring checks sequence and age, calls the monitoring interface, and queues an eligible changed-state snapshot. The notification task maps that snapshot to notification_message_t and calls Slack, Discord, Telegram, and Gmail in order; the shared formatter prepares each native layout. Each service result is logged independently.

Component paths in Table 13 are relative to the components directory. Paths beginning `src/`, `test/`, or `scripts/` are relative to the repository root.

Table 13. Source file responsibilities and connections.

File or group	Responsibility and connection
`src/main.c`; `src/app_tasks.h`	Application entry and task-start interface; connects startup to the coordinator and connectivity
`src/app_tasks.c`	Three tasks, two queues, freshness gate, transition eligibility, captured message data and sequential dispatch
`sensors/include/sensors.h`	Public reading structure and read/init declarations; used by the coordinator
`sensors/sensors.c`	ADC1 channel 0 / GPIO1 and DHT11 / GPIO2; validates reads before publishing outputs
`monitoring/include/monitoring.h`; `monitoring.c` in that component	Confirmation/cooldown state and pure decision logic; called by monitoring task and Unity tests
`connectivity/include/connectivity.h` ; `connectivity.c` in that component	Readiness interface; BLE provisioning, Wi-Fi events/reconnect task, SNTP, event flags
`notifications/include/notifications.h`	Typed snapshot and four synchronous sender declarations; borrowed state stays valid until calls return
`notifications/notification_format.c/.h`	Shared native layouts, PhST conversion, complete fallbacks, Gmail HTML and inline mark
`notifications/notifications.c`	Slack JSON HTTPS sender, bounded retries, Retry-After and shared deadline state
`notifications/discord.c`	Discord HTTPS webhook; disabled mentions and response-wait option
`notifications/telegram.c`	Telegram JSON request and bounded JSON response collection; checks API success
`notifications/gmail.c`	SMTP/TLS session, authentication, MIME body, reply validation and cleanup
`notifications/config.example.h`; local counterpart	Public placeholders versus ignored private values; only the local header contains real credentials
`test/test_monitoring/test_main.c`	Six Unity logic tests; test firmware must be replaced by production firmware after testing
`scripts/test_notification_format.py` ; `tests/host/`	Offline actual-formatter and copied-SMTP tests with real cJSON and dummy settings

File or group	Responsibility and connection
`scripts/refresh_component_cmake.py`	Host pre-build hook that prompts CMake reconfiguration when component declarations change

C.2 Build declarations

The root `CMakeLists.txt` starts the ESP-IDF build. `src/CMakeLists.txt` lists the application C files and dependencies; each component CMake file lists its own sources and exported headers. A header declaration does not compile its implementation. A new sender still needs a source-list entry and a matching definition; the refresh hook does not supply either.

The three `idf_component.yml` manifests declare managed DHT, provisioning, and cJSON dependencies. `dependencies.lock` records their resolutions. `platformio.ini` selects the build/test environment and pre-build hook. `sdkconfig.esp32-s3-devkitc-1` records ESP-IDF settings, and `partitions.csv` defines flash regions including the 4 MB factory app. `config.local.h` remains ignored and outside the submitted repository.

C.3 Timing and error boundaries

Monotonic `sampled_at_us` supports age checks without requiring SNTP; optional `measured_at` stores captured UTC Unix time; the formatter displays a PhST copy for messages. Neither should be substituted for the other. A DHT failure can coexist with a valid ADC result. A stale sample is discarded before processing, whereas a delayed notification is not currently checked again before dispatch. Successful enqueue records cooldown before delivery, and sender acceptance does not establish that a person read the message. These boundaries explain both the source comments and the documented reliability limits.

The Markdown documentation guide, results index, rubric checklist, and verification plan provide navigation beyond this report. They distinguish the original grading requirements from adaptations, recorded observations, and checks still to be performed. The video is deferred and the planned face-to-face demonstration remains a future activity.